

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience in property-related legal work, case administration and client-facing advisory roles. Six-month Real Estate Disputes placement at Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner covering easements, leasehold issues, landlord and tenant disputes, hearing preparation and document management. Currently managing a varied caseload at Citizens Advice East Berkshire, including housing matters, drafting correspondence, preparing document schedules and advising clients on procedural requirements. Organised, deadline-focused and experienced with iManage, case management systems and electronic bundling tools.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit Sept 2024 – Oct 2025

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in dispute resolution, procedural issues, evidence analysis and legal research
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions — Distinction, 75%

Law LLB — 2:1 Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules included Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law and Alternative Dispute Resolution

International Foundation Programme — Law and International Relations Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded Leaders of Tomorrow prize: top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding awarded toward undergraduate degree

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Aug 2023 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation across multiple residential and commercial property matters: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research on easements, rights of light, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Prepared client notes and maintained matter records via iManage; assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements and matter opening and closure
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several concurrent matters with competing deadlines
- Tracked procedural deadlines and assisted with cost comparisons

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Aug 2023 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial
- Drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; amended sections of the memorial and conducted targeted legal research
- Became the sole junior on the team shortly before a significant deadline — coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines; coordinated external translations
- Received partner and associate feedback that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead**July 2026 – Present****Legal Adviser**

- Manages cases from initial instruction through to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets firm deadlines
- Advises clients on housing, welfare benefits, employment, family, debt and consumer matters; takes detailed factual statements and establishes chronologies
- Translates complex procedural requirements into clear, practical guidance for clients, including on landlord and tenant and housing-related issues
- Identifies evidential gaps and researches complex legal points; assesses eligibility against statutory and regulatory criteria

Q-Legal · Remote**Oct 2024 – Jan 2025****Legal Adviser**

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice, under qualified solicitor supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet deadline

Adobe · London**June 2022 – Aug 2022****Legal Intern**

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border data transfer obligations
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: iManage; case management and time-recording systems; electronic bundling and court filing portals; legal and commercial research databases; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; document review; concise report and correspondence drafting

Case and evidence management: Hearing bundle preparation, document-schedule management, matter file organisation, procedural deadline tracking, high-volume document handling across concurrent matters